She-Ra: Daughter of Order

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Teen And Up Audiences

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She-Ra: Daughter of Order

by Crimson_quill

Summary

When Adora stumbles upon the Sword of Power in the Whispering Woods, Destiny takes a darker turn. Instead of becoming the legendary savior of Etheria, she chooses a different path. One that binds her not to honor and protection, but to order and control. With silver hair, blackened armor and the Hordes mark blazing on her chest, Adora rises as a darker She-Ra.

Now Etheria's Fate teeters between rebellion and tyranny as old bonds strain, new loyalties form, and Adora must decide whether she wields her dark power...or if it wields her.

Notes

While writing chapter 2 I kept going back to chapter 1 and something felt off. It took a while but I finally figured out what the problem was. it seemed to one-sided. so I decided to do a rewrite of bow and glimmers sides this I can continue writing my other chapters with both sides of it and it will feel more flushed out that way. plus we get to see the ramifications of Adora staying with the Horde this way from both points of view.

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1.5: The Sword (Glimmer and Bow)

Just after the scene with Shadow Weaver and Adora in the Fright Zone
In a white castle perched upon a mountain beside a sapphire lake, light spilled through tall windows into a grand hall of marble and gold. At the far end, Queen Angella sat upon her throne. Her dual-toned hair of pink and violet shimmered like spun glass in the sun, and her pale purple skin stood in elegant contrast to the throne's gilded frame. Behind her, iridescent wings folded neatly, though there was nothing gentle in the severity of her posture.

"Send her in," she commanded.

Escorted by guards, a young woman strode into the chamber, her steps brisk though her head was bowed. Glimmer's hair, shorter but of the same bright lineage as her mother's, caught the light with the same jewel-toned sheen. She knelt at the foot of the dais, one knee pressed against the polished stone.

"Your Majesty."

Angella's eyes softened only a fraction, her voice remaining clipped. "I am told you disobeyed orders. You led the Rebellion into a combat situation after you were ordered to retreat."

Glimmer's head snapped up. "I was trying to protect a village from falling into the Horde's grasp."

"You were reckless," Angella replied, each word sharpened by exhaustion. "You put yourself and others in danger."

"Fighting is supposed to be dangerous!" Glimmer's voice rose, passion breaking through her formality. "How are we going to hold

our own if we keep retreating? If we keep running, we won't have anything left to defend!"

Angella's wings tightened. "I am growing tired of your back-talking, Commander Glimmer."

"Then why make me a commander if you won't let me fight?" Glimmer demanded, her voice echoing through the vaulted hall.

"That's enough!" Angella's tone cracked like a whip. "You're grounded."

"Mom!" Glimmer scoffed, indignation flashing in her eyes.

"You heard me." The queen's voice was firm, but the tightness in her brow betrayed her weariness.

"You never let me do anything!"

"We are not having this discussion tonight," Angella said sharply, standing taller, wings lifting with authority. "You are embarrassing me in front of the court."

"Oh, I'm embarrassing you?" Glimmer laughed bitterly.

"Go to your room!" Angella snapped, her voice breaking with anger.

"I'm going!" Glimmer shouted, storming from the chamber.

The queen let out a long breath and pressed a hand to her temple, a frown creasing her brow as the court shifted uneasily. A ripple goes through the world here

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Later that night, Glimmer sat sprawled across a chaise lounge in her chamber, the soft glow of her lantern casting long shadows.

Her journal lay open in her lap, and her quill scratched angrily against the page.

Dear Mom, I know you'll never read this, but I have to say it somewhere. I feel like you don't respect me.

A sudden thunk split the air. Glimmer shrieked, the quill jerking across the page as an arrow lodged in the wall above her head. A note unfurled from its shaft.

"Seriously?!" she hissed, tugging it free. The note read: Look outside.

She groaned and leaned out her window. Below, Bow stood in the moonlight, waving cheerfully.

"Hey, Glimmer!"

"Watch it! You almost hit me!" she hissed down at him.

"What? I can't hear you!" he shouted back. "Come down here!"

"I can't, I'm grounded!" she whispered furiously.

"What?"

She rolled her eyes, then with a snap of magic vanished from her room and reappeared beside him. "Grounded," she said pointedly. With another burst of light, she teleported him into her bedroom.

"Whoa!" Bow yelped, stumbling as he landed.

Glimmer flopped onto her bed, glaring at the ceiling. "I'm so mad at my mom."

"This about Elberon?" Bow asked, already tidying up stray clothes scattered across her floor.

"I was just trying to defend the village," she snapped. "It was the perfect chance to prove I can lead. But she acts like I'm still just a princess, like I can't do anything!"

“That doesn’t make sense,” Bow said, folding a tunic and looking around for a drawer. “Everyone here’s a princess. I’m the only one who’s not.”

“Tell that to my mom,” Glimmer muttered, arms crossed.

He held up the folded tunic. “Where does this go?”

“Bottom drawer.” She pointed.

He slid it away neatly, then turned, his voice gentler. “Look, your mom might have a point. The only reason you got out of Elberon was because of your teleporting. And… well, let’s face it, those don’t always land where you want them.”

Glimmer groaned. “I was looking for support here, Bow.”

“I’m just saying, if you want to prove yourself, it’s gonna take more than throwing yourself into battle. Luckily…” He grinned, hopping onto her hanging platform bed. “I’ve got just the thing.” He pulled a tracker pad from his satchel, the screen glowing faintly. “I picked up a First Ones signal in the Whispering Woods. Big one, too. If you find this and bring it back, your mom won’t be able to say you don’t contribute.”

Glimmer hugged her knees, eyes flicking to the window. “Did you forget? I’m grounded.”

A knock rattled her door.

“Glimmer?” Angella’s voice came muffled from the hall.

Glimmer’s eyes widened. She grabbed Bow and, with a flash, teleported him back to the forest’s edge. She reappeared by her door, smoothing her hair. “Everything’s fine, Mom.”

“Is someone else in there?” Angella pressed, her tone suspicious. “I heard voices.”

“No one else is in here,” Glimmer said quickly. “Can you please just leave me alone?”

“I don’t appreciate your tone, young lady.”

“What tone?”

“That attitude of yours will never serve you.”

“You always tell me what to do–”

“You cannot act this way!”

“–And that’s not fair!” Glimmer shouted, slamming the door. She vanished in another flash, reappearing beside Bow at the forest’s edge. Her face was flushed, her eyes hard.

“I’m in.”

The Whispering Woods was alive with shifting light and whispering branches. Bow walked with his tracker pad raised, its glow bouncing across the mossy floor.

“Come on, come on,” he muttered, tapping the screen.

“Please tell me we’re not lost,” Glimmer groaned.

Bow smacked the side of the pad. “No, no, it’s just overloaded. The signal’s too strong. That means we’re close.”

A glow flickered in the distance.

“Uh… I think it’s that way,” Glimmer said, pointing.

“What makes you say that?”

She just stared at him.

“Oh. Yeah. That’ll do it.” Bow grinned sheepishly.

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“The light came from the edge of the forest,” Bow said, tapping his screen.

“Yes,” she snapped, “but the light is this way.”

“The tracker says otherwise,” Bow argued, still tapping his screen.

“Bow, just let me lead,” she said, pushing a branch aside, irritation heavy in her tone.

They stepped into a clearing and see a sword straight in front of them, “It’s this way,” Glimmer stopped short as her gaze locked onto Adora. Her expression sharpened in an instant.
“Horde soldier!”

“I see her!” Bow chimed in, clearly rattled.

Adora’s breath caught, panic flaring. Without thinking, she bolted toward the sword. But Glimmer was fast, she vanished in a shimmer of light and reappeared at the blade’s side, seizing it before Adora could reach it.

“Bow, catch!” she shouted, tossing the sword toward him.

Adora’s voice rang with authority, a command drilled into her bones. “Give me the sword.”

Glimmer darted forward, launching herself onto Adora’s back. Snarling, Adora flung her off, spinning with soldier’s precision and whipping a thrown weapon at Bow’s feet. He stumbled, dropping the sword as it clattered to the ground.

“Stand down!” Adora barked, breath harsh. “I don’t want to hurt you. But I will if I have to.”

Glimmer laughed bitterly. “Since when do Horde soldiers not want to hurt people?”
Glimmer hurled a ball of light, and it burst against Adora’s face in a shower of glittering sparks. She coughed, swiping at the blinding haze just as Glimmer lunged for the sword. Adora reacted on instinct, slamming into her. Bow dove in, and the three of them tumbled across the forest floor in a frantic struggle.

Adora’s fingers brushed the hilt of the blade.

A pulse of darkness erupted. Her vision swam, and then, nothing. She crumpled, unconscious.

“Quick, tie her hands!” Glimmer’s voice shook with urgency.

Bow yanked a coil of rope from his quiver, working fast to bind Adora’s wrists. “What’s a Horde soldier doing in the Whispering Woods?” he muttered.

“I don’t know,” Glimmer admitted, panic edging her words, “but it can’t be good. We have to bring her to Bright Moon for questioning.”

Adora groaned, stirring. “Wha–”

“She’s waking up!” Bow warned, nerves creeping into his voice.

Adora blinked groggily, head pounding. “What… happened?”

“Quiet, Horde spy,” Glimmer snapped, stepping closer. “I’ll ask the questions. How did you get this far into the Whispering Woods?”

“I walked in. And I’m not a spy,” Adora shot back, incredulous.

“Sure,” Glimmer said with mocking disbelief. “And I suppose you just ‘happened’ to stumble across our sword, too?”

Adora’s eyes narrowed. “It’s not yours. I found it first.”

“The Whispering Woods is under the Rebellion’s protection,” Glimmer retorted. “You’re lucky you made it this far. Come on, Bow. We’ll take her back to Bright Moon where she can be interrogated properly. This is perfect. Not only do we have First Ones tech, we’ve also captured a Horde soldier. My mom’s going to be very impressed.”

She gestured sharply. “On your feet.”

The forest pressed in on them like a labyrinth, endless trunks and shadows winding back upon themselves until even Bow’s steady confidence faltered.

“You’re positive we’re going the right way, Glimmer?” he asked, his bowstring tapping nervously against his leg. His eyes darted between the trees, as if half-expecting them to shift when he wasn’t looking.

“I know what I’m doing,” Glimmer shot back, more defensively than she meant. She tapped at the tracker pad furiously, “Can you please just trust me for once?”

“You know I always trust you,” Bow said, though the worry in his voice betrayed him. “It’s just…I grew up in these woods, and I’ve never seen this place before. I’ve heard stories about weird things happening out here.”

“It’s fine,” Glimmer insisted, marching ahead as if she could outpace her own unease. “Just let me figure this out.”

“Okay! Touchy,” Bow muttered, then glanced behind him at their prisoner.

Adora walked stiffly, wrists bound tight with rope, her Horde uniform marked with dirt and torn edges. She met his glance with a glare that could have frozen stone.

“Sorry about her,” Bow said, lowering his voice. “She’s usually really nice.”

Adora’s voice cut sharp and cold. “I prefer not to exchange pleasantries with my captors.”

“Fair enough,” Bow admitted with a shrug, though his eyes lingered on her, studying the soldier who looked no older than they were, “I’m Bow by the way.”

A long silence went between them before Adora finally answered, “Adora.”

Glimmer disappeared in a flicker of light, reappearing several paces ahead. Adora arched her brow. “You know she’s a princess, right?” She nodded toward Glimmer. “How can you follow her? Princesses are dangerous. That’s common knowledge. They’re unstable threats to everyone on Etheria.”

Bow blinked at her, incredulous. “Is that what Hordak told you?”

Adora straightened, chin lifted. “It doesn’t need telling. It’s true. They’re violent instigators who can’t even control their own powers.”

From up ahead came a strangled cry of frustration. Glimmer stood frozen before the ruins of what had once been a village, its huts burned to ash and walls crumbled to blackened stone. She bent and picked up a fragment from the wreckage, a child’s drawing, smeared with soot, showing a stick-figure family holding hands.

“What happened here?” Adora asked, her voice quiet, almost reverent.

Glimmer whirled on her, eyes blazing. “Don’t play dumb with me. I bet you were part of the raiding party that did this.”

“I wasn’t!” Adora snapped. “The Horde didn’t do this.”

“Oh yeah?” Glimmer dragged her to a scorched clearing, shoving her down before the shattered husk of a Horde automaton. Its red eye flickered faintly before winking out. “Explain this. You and your people are all the same, destroyers all of you.”

Adora stared at it, her throat dry. “I’m not a destroyer. Hordak says we’re… we’re making Etheria better. Bringing order.”

“Order?” Glimmer barked out a laugh that was closer to a sob. “Ever since the Horde arrived, they’ve poisoned our rivers, burned our cities, and destroyed everything in their path. And you’re a part of it! How’s that for order?”

Adora staggered back, her mind reeled. None of this matched what she had been told. “This doesn’t make sense. The Horde would never…” She faltered. “They must have been hiding something. A weapon. A fugitive. There has to be a reason.”

Bow’s voice was softer, but it cut deeper than Glimmer’s accusations. “Did you really not know any of this? Your army is called the Evil Horde.”

Adora blinked at him, stricken. “Who calls us that?”

“Everybody!”

She shook her head, defiant, but her voice wavered. “The Horde rescued me when I was a baby. They gave me a home. They’re my family. You don’t know them like I do.”

“Maybe you don’t know them the way you think you do,” Bow said quietly.

Before she could answer, Glimmer sprinted back into view, panic in her eyes. “Something’s out there. Something big.”

“How big?” Bow asked.

The earth split open beneath their feet, and the forest shook. With a shriek like tearing metal, a massive insectoid beast erupted

from the ground, its six bladed limbs slashing at the air.

Bow's voice cracked. "So… pretty big."

The creature lunged. Glimmer teleported onto its back, hurling a cascade of shimmering light-bombs, but the monster shook her off like dust. She slammed into a tree, gasping, the sword clattered to the ground.

Adora stumbled as the ground cracked, one boot wedging tight in the roots. She yanked against her bonds, helpless. The beast pivoted toward her, mandibles clicking.

"Watch out!" Bow shouted, firing an arrow. Webbing burst across the creature's face, binding its mouth. It thrashed furiously, ripping itself free. Bow loosed another shot, but one of the creature's limbs swiped him aside, hurling him into the dirt.

Adora tore her foot free at last, falling hard to her knees. Her eyes locked on the sword lying on the ground, sparking faintly with caged lightning.

Glimmer dragged herself upright, staggering as she threw another desperate barrage of glittering energy. The monster barreled toward her.

Adora surged forward, seized the sword from the ground, and the world seemed to hold its breath. Electricity danced across the blade, crawling up her arms, burning with a power she had never known but somehow recognized.

Bow and Glimmer stared at her, wide-eyed, expecting salvation.

But Adora did not raise the sword for them.

Instead, she turned. The world seemed to ripple with her choice, the air bending unnaturally around her. Without a word, Adora walked toward the horizon—toward the Fright Zone. Toward home.

Bow and Glimmer's hope curdled into horror as they watched her go.

The creature screeched, its massive mandibles snapping inches from them. Glimmer's breath caught; she squeezed her eyes shut and clutched Bow's arm. The monster lunged, and in a flash of light, they were gone.

The teleport burned what little energy Glimmer had left. She collapsed mid-jump, dragging Bow with her as they reappeared high above the forest.

"Glimmer!" Bow shouted as the two of them plummeted. Thinking fast, he yanked an arrow from his quiver and fired. The head burst apart midair, weaving a net beneath them. They hit hard but safely, tumbling into its hold.

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Glimmer stirred, groaning, her head rolling weakly to one side. She blinked up to find Bow carrying her in his arms, his shirt torn and a rough bandage wrapped around his bleeding arm.

"Wha– where are we?" she murmured groggily.

"Just outside Thaymoar," Bow said, voice steady but tight with pain. "It was the closest town I could reach."

Glimmer winced, covering her face with her hand. "Ugh. My mom is going to kill me."

Bow didn't answer right away. His jaw was set, eyes dark. Finally, he said, "Regardless… we need to get back to Bright Moon. Soon. We have to tell her." He looked down the road, his voice dropping. "We have to tell her about Adora. About She-Ra."

End Notes

Thank you for reading this chapter I promise I am working hard on chapter 2: The Siege on Thaymoar. I am also posting these on my tumblr @crimson-quill

tumblr link: https://www.tumblr.com/crimson-quill?source=share

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!